UNSTUCK: WINNING THE UAE JOB HUNT ON YOUR TERMS



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Introduction: why you’re not getting replies and how this guide changes that

Hi, I’m Darija Meško and I know how it feels to be ignored.

You tweak your CV. You hit "apply" again and again. You get nothing. No calls. No feedback. Just silence. And in the UAE? That silence can feel brutal.

When I moved to Dubai, I was blown away. The diversity, the ambition, the heat, the food. But I also saw something else: thousands of highly qualified people stuck in job search limbo. People applying to 100+ jobs a week, pouring their energy into a system that never gave them a roadmap.

I don’t want that for you. That’s why I wrote this guide. Not to just tell you how to job hunt, but to hand you the actual tools to win in this market.

Because here’s the truth. The UAE job market doesn’t care how hardworking or talented you are. It cares how visible, how clear, and how strategic you are.

I’ve reviewed over 10,000 CVs and hired more than 1,000 people across Europe, the US, and the GCC. I’ve been the recruiter. I’ve been the candidate. I’ve led teams who filled 20+ roles a month. And again and again, I saw amazing people getting ignored. Not because they weren’t good enough, but because they didn’t know how the system actually works.

This Playbook changes that.

Inside, I’ll walk you through everything step by step

How the UAE job market works
How to reach out to recruiters (with exact message scripts)
How to get noticed on LinkedIn (without sounding fake)
How to find jobs that aren’t even posted online
How to use events, AI tools, and daily planning to stay consistent
How to stop wasting time and start getting interviews that count

This is the guide I wish someone had given me when I started. No fluff. No recycled advice. Just what works. Whether you’re brand new to the UAE or you've been stuck in this search for months, you’re not alone anymore. You’ve got a guide now. You’ve got a plan. And you’ve got me.

Your job search just became a lot more powerful.

How the UAE job market works

The big three: CV, LinkedIn, and cover letter

Every job hunt needs these three:

- A strong CV
- A standout LinkedIn profile
- And sometimes, a cover letter

Now, let's not sugarcoat it. A cover letter is not always required. Some companies won't even ask for it. But if they do? You give them one. End of story. No excuses. If they request it and you skip it, you're already giving someone else a better shot because you have just been **rejected.** *Did you know that there are a looot of things automated in recruitment? Okay, I'm getting ahead of myself...*

So, let's start with the first and most important tool in your kit.

Your CV

Your CV is the one knocking on the door... ...but if it doesn't pass the **ATS** and show your value to the recruiter, the door stays shut.

Your CV must pass 2 steps. First step is ATS & the second is a recruiter's check.

Step 1: The ATS (Applicant Tracking System)

When you apply for a job, your CV doesn't go straight to a recruiter. It goes through an ATS, a robot that filters out applications before a human even gets to see them. Why? Because of the sheer volume.

Every single job post here gets between 2,000 to 4,000 applications. And recruiters are often hiring for multiple roles at once. That means 10,000 to 20,000 CVs to filter through. It's impossible to do it manually.

So the ATS scans your CV for structure, keywords, and clarity. Not creativity, not beauty, just data. It's harsh, but that's how it works.

The scary truth is that 96% of CVs never pass the ATS.

If your CV isn't built for ATS, it's gone. No one even lays eyes on it. And if you're using designs from Canva or any creative templates, it's like sending a blank document. The system just can't read it.

Do you remember when I said things are automated? This is one of the things! If you don´t pass the ATS you get ***automatically rejected*** *and nobody will even know you exist.*

Step 2: The Recruiter Check

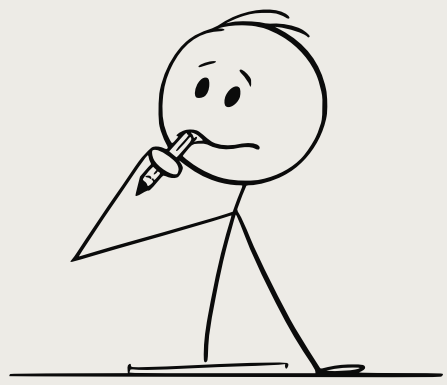
Let's say you pass the ATS. Great! But it's only the beginning.

Now, your CV goes to a recruiter. And they have just one question in mind: What can this person bring to the company?

If your CV doesn't immediately show:

- What value you bring to the company.
- How your skills solve their problems.

You're **rejected**. Just like that. They won't bother trying to figure it out. It's brutal, but it's the reality. ***Do you think you have those two steps under the roof?***



Your LinkedIn

The third step you can easily get **rejected** is LinkedIn.

Your LinkedIn is your digital face... ...if it doesn't feel personal, if it's made by AI, nobody will connect with it. You can definitely get rejected just because of that. How you represent yourself online is super important. Why? Because when you work at the ___ company you represent them as well.

Okay, so you made it past the recruiter check. Amazing! But you're still not in the clear. Every recruiter, after reviewing your CV, will always check your LinkedIn profile. Always. And if it's not properly structured, if it's not aligned with your CV, if it doesn't follow the hidden formula recruiters use, then you're invisible.

Most people don't understand: LinkedIn is your digital proof. It's your credibility, your visibility. And if it's not done the right way, you lose everything you worked for in the previous steps.

Be aware! LinkedIn should NEVER be a copy paste from your CV. CV has its own tone, language,.. and your LinkedIn profile has a different tone, different fields, and each field on LinkedIn has it´s own purpose and only HR people know exactly what should be included.

It breaks my heart because I see it all the time. Talented people who pass the ATS, impress the recruiter with their CV, and then fail because their LinkedIn is just a mess.

So let's break it down:

- Your photo should feel warm and approachable. No filters. No cropped group photos. Look into the camera and smile like you'd in real life.
- Your headline is not your job title or where you went to school. It´s about the right keywords. This is what recruiters find YOU with. That's way more powerful than "Sales executive seeking opportunities."
- Your About section is where your voice matters. Tell a story. What drives you? What industries do you love? What kind of work lights you up? Be honest. Be confident. This is not where you write like a robot.
- Your Experience section needs to match your CV but should never be a copy. LinkedIn plays a different role in the recruitment process, so it can´t be written in the same way as your CV. Think of it like "proof with personality." What did you do? What impact did you make?
- Your Activity should show life. Comment on posts. Celebrate others. Share your thoughts, not just job posts. When recruiters see you engaging, they remember you.

This isn't about being perfect.

It's about being real. Being memorable. Showing who you are and what you care about.

Your LinkedIn doesn't need to scream "hire me." It just needs to say, clearly and confidently: "Here's the kind of impact I make."

Make sure your timeline and job titles on LinkedIn match your CV. Don't lie. It screams scam. It's a huge red flag. We see it, and we run right after we **reject** you.

Step 4: The Pre-Screening Interview

If you've made it this far, you're doing great. But now you have to face the first interview.Usually, it's a call or video interview with HR or a recruiter.

And here's the reality: They'll hit you with those nightmare questions like:

- Where do you see yourself in five years?
- What's your biggest weakness?
- Why should we hire you?

You need to be ready for these. Your answers need to align with your CV and LinkedIn. You need to create a story. If your story doesn't make sense, if you sound unsure or unprepared, you're out.

Step 5: The Real Interview Rounds

If you pass all of that? Now you're in the final rounds.

And sometimes it's two rounds, sometimes it's five, sometimes even seven. And it gets tougher each time. They are testing your consistency, your knowledge, your passion, and how you fit with their culture.

And here's the part that nobody wants to hear:

If your CV is weak, if your LinkedIn is a mess, if you're not ready for the interview questions, you will keep getting rejected. And it's not because you're not good enough. It's because you're not presenting yourself the right way.

Now, let me tell you about the most common mistakes that keep people from getting jobs:

1. Using ChatGPT or AI to Write Your CV

This is the biggest trap people fall into. AI doesn't understand the UAE market, it doesn't know what recruiters are looking for, and it's not trained to navigate the ATS. It just grabs random phrases from the internet and gives you generic templates. And recruiters know this. They spot these AI-generated CVs instantly and reject them.
Please read this FREE article on our website why you should never use ChatGPT or any other AI tools.

2. Using Canva or Creative Templates

They look beautiful, but they’re completely useless for ATS. It’s like submitting a blank document. The system can’t read it. And it doesn’t matter how good you are if your CV can’t be read.

3. Ignoring LinkedIn

This is the biggest tragedy. So many talented people pass the ATS and impress the recruiter only to be rejected because their LinkedIn isn’t optimized. It’s devastating.

If your CV is not ATS-readable, you’re wasting your time. If your LinkedIn is not structured properly, you’re invisible. And if you don’t prepare for the interviews, you’re out.

Then comes the recruiter check

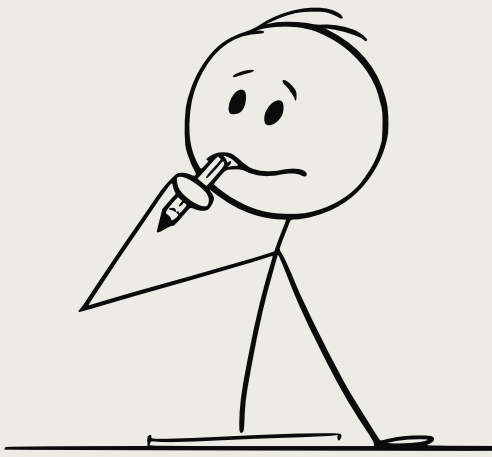
Let’s say your CV does pass the ATS. Now a recruiter sees it. And they ask themselves one question.

What can this candidate bring to the table? Not in five years. Not in theory. Right now.

Recruiters are scanning for proof. Your past behaviour (your previous achievements, your track record, your work results) is the biggest predictor of what you'll do in the future.

That’s what they’re looking at. That’s what you need to show. Not just responsibilities. Not just a list of tasks. If your CV is vague or filled with irrelevant info, you’re out.
Not because you’re not good enough. But because someone else made their value easier to see.

Do you think you have those two steps under the roof?



Your cover letter

The cover letter is not always required. But when it is... you better give them one. Not a generic copy. Not something filled with fluff. A real letter that shows why you get them and why they should want you because when a recruiter asks for a cover letter, they're not just checking a box. They're testing one thing:

Do you care enough to communicate like a human?

But what's the point of a cover letter?

It's not a summary of your CV. It's not a "hello I'm applying" template.

It's your chance to speak directly to the hiring manager and say:

- I understand your company
- I understand the role
- Here's why I can bring value
- And here's why I'm excited about it

That's it. Keep it short. Keep it specific. Make it feel human.



A recruiter reading your cover letter is thinking:

- "Have they done any research on us?"
- "Are they just applying to everything?"
- "Do they actually care about this role?"
- "What's the one thing they bring that stands out?"

If your letter is vague, too long, or filled with corporate nonsense, they'll stop reading after the second line.

When to write one:

- If the job ad asks for it
- If you’re switching industries or roles (explain the “why”)
- If you have a referral or insider connection
- If you’re applying cold and want to make an impression
- If the company is small, values culture, or has a strong brand voice

When to skip it:

- If the portal doesn’t allow it
- If the recruiter says it’s not needed
- If you’re reapplying to the same company in a short window

Otherwise? Don’t overthink it, just write it well.

If your CV is ATS-readable, passed the check with the recruiter, and your LinkedIn is on point, you just did 90% of everything! Can you imagine? But this is only IF you actually did that.

If you’re not sure, don’t stay stuck. Send me a DM or email and say this:

Hi, I read your Playbook and you mentioned that you can check my CV, LinkedIn, and cover letter. Can you please take a look so I can move forward with my job search?

... or something similar and I will get back to you.

From preparation mode to action mode

You've got your tools. Your CV is done. It's clear, easy to read, and shows what you bring to the table. Your LinkedIn looks like a real person wrote it. It shows confidence, not just keywords. Your cover letter? You send it when it's needed. It's short, human, and to the point.

So what now?

Now it's time to find the jobs. And here's something most people don't talk about. There isn't one way that works. In fact, most people stay stuck because they're doing just one thing and expecting it to work every time.

If you only apply through job portals, you'll miss a big part of the market. If you wait for recruiters to message you, you might be waiting for weeks. If you only network and never apply, you could be missing real roles that are already out there.

In the UAE, you have to show up in more than one place. Some jobs are posted online. Some get filled before the ad is even written. Some are shared in WhatsApp groups, LinkedIn posts, or events. Some are filled by recruiters who already have someone in mind, and if they don't know you exist, they won't reach out.

This part of the Playbook is all about action. You've done the prep. Now it's about moving forward and getting visible. I'll show you how to work with recruitment agencies without wasting your time. I'll show you how to search properly on LinkedIn, how to follow companies and not just job ads, how to write messages that get replies, and how to use events and communities to make real connections.

This isn't about doing everything all at once. It's about building a system that works for you. Something you can do every day that moves you forward. Because job searching isn't sitting and waiting. It's showing up again and again until the right person sees you.

LET´S GO...





Starting again with LinkedIn

This is where most people get it wrong. They think LinkedIn is just about polishing their profile and waiting. It's not. This is the platform where most jobs in the UAE are found, but only if you know how to use it to take action. You're not here to scroll. You're here to connect with the right people and get seen by the ones who make decisions.

So here's what to do. First, go to any AI tool. ChatGPT works perfectly fine. Tell it what experience you have, from which industries, and in which types of roles. Based on that, ask it to give you a list of 100 companies that operate in the UAE, or even just in Dubai or Abu Dhabi.

Prompt:

I have five years of experience working in event operations and client servicing. I've worked on conferences, product launches, and VIP experiences in both agency and in-house environments. Give me a list of 100 companies in Dubai and Abu Dhabi that work in event production, event marketing, brand activations, or large-scale event logistics. Include agencies and in-house event teams if possible.

This is your personal company list. These are the places you will be targeting. Now go one by one. For every single company on that list, open their LinkedIn page. Click on the "People" section. This is where you'll find who works there.

Here's where most people mess it up. They start adding random people, or people who are at the same level as them. Do not do that. You are not here to add people who feel threatened by you. You are here to connect with the people who can actually open a door. That means people who are at least two levels above you.

You're looking for recruiters and HR staff working in that company, in the right location. And then you're looking for senior leaders from the department or industry you're in. Those are the only people worth adding. Do this for every company in your list.

Find the right people. Save their names if you need to. Write a short message when you add them, and don't worry, I'll give you the exact message to send in the next section. But first, you need to build this list properly.

This is what it means to use LinkedIn in action mode. You are not waiting for a job to appear. You're showing up where decisions are made.

Reach out to people in the right way

Do not start with “Hope this message finds you well.”
Don’t say you’re a hardworking team player.
Don’t compliment someone’s profile just because you don’t know what else to say.

Hi, my name is Aisha and I’m currently looking for a role in HR within the events industry in Dubai. I have ten years of experience working in the UAE across recruitment, learning and development, budgeting, performance reviews, employee engagement, and onboarding.

I’ve led high-volume hiring projects of 50+ people per quarter, built recruitment strategies from scratch for both agencies and internal HR teams, and set up onboarding and internal training programs across three departments. I also have a strong network of HR professionals within the events space, which helps me stay close to industry trends and hiring needs.

I saw that your company focuses on events hiring, so I’d be happy to connect and stay in touch in case something comes up.

The LinkedIn message formula

Stop guessing what to write. Here’s the structure that works.

1. Start with who you are.
Tell them your name, the kind of role you’re looking for, and in what industry.

2. Say where you’ve worked and what your focus areas are.
List the main categories you’ve worked in that are relevant to the role. Keep it clean.

3. Add 2 or 3 real achievements.
Mention numbers, scope, and what you’ve actually done. Be specific.

4. Say why you’re reaching out to them.
This is not a copy-paste message. Mention something that connects you to that company or person.

5. End simply.
You’re not asking for a job. You’re opening a door.

Company websites

Not every job is posted on LinkedIn. In fact, a lot of companies only post a few roles there, even when they're hiring for much more.

Why? Because LinkedIn is expensive.

To post jobs on LinkedIn, companies often pay between three to seven thousand dollars per month. And in that package, they usually get only three job slots. So if they're hiring for seven roles, they'll only post the three most urgent or high-level ones. The rest? You'll only find them on their own website. That's why checking company pages is a must.

When you build your list of 100 companies using ChatGPT or your own research, don't stop at LinkedIn. Go to their official website. Look for a menu item that says Careers or Join Us. Every serious company has one. And that's where they often list jobs they're not paying to advertise anywhere else.

Companies also update those pages faster than LinkedIn. So you might find a fresh role on the website that hasn't even gone public yet.

This is your edge.

This is how you find the roles that other people miss.

So here's what you do:

1. Take your list of companies.
2. Open their website.
3. Check their Careers page.
4. See if they're hiring.
5. Apply there directly, or use it as the reason to message someone on LinkedIn.

It's that simple. It just takes time. But this step alone can open doors that LinkedIn never will.

Other job platforms in the UAE

Job platforms are flooded. Most people apply to 50 jobs in one day, then wonder why nobody calls. It's not just about how many you apply for. It's about how you apply, where you apply, and whether you're even a match for that job in the first place.

There are a few job platforms that actually work in the UAE. But each one works better for a different industry or job level. Use them with intention, not desperation.

Here are the main ones to focus on:

1. LinkedIn Jobs
This is your number one. If you've fixed your profile and you're active, LinkedIn works really well. You can set alerts, save job searches, and apply directly. Just never use Easy Apply with a bad CV. Your CV must be ready.

2. Indeed UAE
Good for general roles, especially admin, sales, logistics, and customer support. But check the posting date. A lot of old listings stay live for weeks. If it's been up for more than 14 days and has hundreds of applicants, skip it and focus elsewhere.

3. Bayt
Popular in the Gulf region. Better for mid to senior roles. You'll need to build your profile properly and actually log in often. Dead profiles don't get seen. If you're applying for something serious here, upload a fresh CV and write a short summary about what you do best. Again, I repeat, it has to be human writing, make it personal.

4. GulfTalent
Used by many larger companies and recruiters, especially in finance, consulting, and corporate roles. If you're in those fields, this one is worth checking weekly.

5. Naukrigulf
Not as strong, but still works for entry-level and retail jobs. Set alerts and check weekly. Don't spend hours here.

6. AngelList (now called Wellfound)
This one is more for startups. If you're looking for something flexible, hybrid, or more creative, check here. Just remember that not all roles are UAE-based, so always filter by location.

A few reminders:

Do not apply to everything just because it’s there.
Do not send the same CV to every role.
Do not waste your energy on platforms that never worked for your industry.

Track where you applied. Follow up when it makes sense. Be selective and smart.
You're not applying for attention. You're applying for a role where you can actually add value. Big difference.

Recruitment agencies in the UAE

Who to contact based on your industry

Let’s not waste time. Not every recruitment agency is right for you. Some only work with executive roles. Some only hire locals. Some focus on mass hiring. Some don’t even bother replying unless you’re already in their database. So don’t spam all of them. Target the ones that actually place people in your field.

Here’s a list of well-known agencies in the UAE, sorted by industry.

MARKETING, COMMUNICATIONS, PR, MEDIA	EVENTS, HOSPITALITY, ENTERTAINMENT
• Kingston Stanley • MCG Talent • Taurus Marketing Recruitment • The Works Search • Charterhouse (also covers digital and comms)	• **The Fridge Entertainment** • **TMI Talent Management** • **Platinumlist** • **Katch International** (PR and events) • **Emirates Flight Catering Careers** (for catering/events ops roles)
HR, PEOPLE, ADMIN	**TECH, PRODUCT, IT**
• Inspire Selection • Michael Page • Charterhouse • Hays • Robert Half • Talent BluePrint	• Tiro Partners • Salt Recruitment • Robert Walters • Huxley • Michael Page Tech

FINANCE, BANKING, CONSULTING	CONSTRUCTION, ENGINEERING, LOGISTICS
• Michael Page Finance • Robert Half Finance and Accounting • Charterhouse • Hays Finance • BAC Middle East	• **Guildhall Recruitment** • **WRS (Worldwide Recruitment Solutions)** • **Ignite Selection** • **Blake Anderson** • **Kershaw Leonard**
CREATIVE, DESIGN, ARCHITECTURE	**LEGAL, COMPLIANCE, RISK**
• Salt • TMI • Charterhouse • Ignite Selection (also covers engineering and design) • HR Source	• Robert Walters • Taylor Root • Michael Page Legal • Hays Legal • Jameson Legal
HEALTHCARE, MEDICAL, PHARMA	**EDUCATION, TEACHING, TRAINING**
• Davidson Management Consultants • Medacs Healthcare • Prospect Health • Global Medical Recruiting • Cassia • MENA Recruit (healthcare admin roles)	• Teach Away • GEMS Education (internal HR/recruitment) • Edvectus • SeekTeachers • SABIS Careers • Al Nibras Careers
OIL, GAS, ENERGY, SUSTAINABILITY	**GOVERNMENT, SEMI-GOVERNMENT, FREE ZONES**
• NES Fircroft • WTS Energy • Brunel • Airswift • Fuschia Careers • Worley (internal recruitment, often via agencies)	Some hiring is direct, but these agencies often place into them: • Cooper Fitch • Inspire Selection • Michael Page • Hays

How to work with recruitment agencies the smart way

Now that you know who to contact, here's how to do it without wasting your time or theirs.

1. Only contact agencies that work in your field.
Read their website. Check the jobs they post. Look at their LinkedIn. If they haven't posted anything in your industry for months, move on. Some agencies focus only on tech. Some only hire for senior roles. Some cover multiple industries. You need to find the ones that match your background and your goals.

2. Don't send just your CV.
Always include a short message. Say what kind of role you're looking for, how many years of experience you have, and what kinds of companies you've worked with. Be clear about your industry experience too. If you've worked in events, hospitality, fintech, education, or anything else, say it. That gives the recruiter context and helps them understand where you fit.

3. Be specific.
Say something like, "I'm looking for a mid-level HR role in the events or hospitality industry in Dubai. I have 5.5 years of experience in HR roles within the events space and another 2.5 years in hospitality. I also have a strong network of HR professionals and freelancers in these industries, which really helps when it comes to recruitment, onboarding, and referrals."

That's the kind of message that gets noticed. Not "I'm open to anything in HR." The more specific you are, the easier it is for the recruiter to actually imagine you in a role they're hiring for.

4. Don't ghost them and don't chase them.
If they reply, great. Be responsive and respectful. If they don't, it usually means they don't have something right now. You can follow up once or twice, but not every two days. Nobody likes pressure. Stay professional.

5. Keep them updated.
If you move cities, change industries, or shift your job title, tell them. If you see a role they post and it fits you, apply and message them directly with why you're a match. Recruiters appreciate people who stay visible and relevant.

6. Track who you messaged.
Use a simple Google Sheet. Note the agency name, recruiter name, date contacted, what you said, and any replies. This keeps you from repeating yourself or forgetting who you already reached out to. It shows you're organised and most people are not.

Real networking happens offline too

Events in the UAE that actually matter

Here’s something a lot of job seekers don’t want to hear but need to.

If you’re only applying online and never showing up in real life, you’re missing out on jobs that never get posted. In the UAE, networking is everything. The job market here is fast, personal, and full of last-minute openings that go to people someone already knows. That means attending events isn’t just a nice extra. It’s part of the job search. It’s where you shake hands with the right people, hear what roles are coming soon, and get remembered.

And I don’t mean going to expos just to collect flyers. You need to show up prepared. You need to speak to people. You need to follow up. That’s where the real magic happens.

What kind of events should you attend?

It depends on your industry, but here’s a simple rule: If your industry is gathering, you should be there.

Whether it’s a tech summit, HR breakfast, fashion trade show, or startup pitch night if those are your people, go meet them.

You'll find:

Hiring managers
Startup founders
Recruiters
HR professionals
Team leads
People who can refer you

where to find these events

Most people don't know where to look. Here's where to start:

1. LinkedIn Events
Yes, LinkedIn has an Events tab. Use it. Filter by location and topic. Many events are free or low-cost. These are often hosted by companies, coaches, or business hubs.

2. Meetup.com
Great for community events, networking nights, and informal industry meetups. Especially useful if you're in tech, marketing, design, wellness, or sustainability.

3. Eventbrite.ae
Search by city, category, and date. Lots of business and job-seeking events show up here.

4. Dubai Calendar and Abu Dhabi Calendar
Official city platforms that list public events, including business expos, workshops, government initiatives, and networking gatherings.

5. Free zones and coworking spaces
Places like DIFC, DMCC, D3, Hub71, Astrolabs, and in5 often host talks and mixers. Follow them on LinkedIn or Instagram.

6. Industry-specific expos

For example:

- Arab Health (healthcare)
- GITEX (tech and AI)
- Middle East Film and Comic Con (media, animation, entertainment)
- Gulf Education and Training Exhibition
- Cityscape (real estate and architecture)
- The Hotel Show (hospitality)
- Dubai International Boat Show (luxury, sales, marine industry)
- Beautyworld Middle East (retail, beauty, luxury)



How to prepare for events

1. Know who’s attending.
Check the speakers, companies, and sponsors in advance. Choose 5 to 10 people or companies you want to meet. Make a short plan.

2. Prepare your pitch.
Have a 10-second version of who you are and what you’re looking for. Not a full CV speech. Just one line that’s clear.

3. Bring business cards or have your LinkedIn QR code ready.
Most people won’t remember names. Make it easy for them.

4. Follow up after.
Send a short message on LinkedIn. Say “Nice meeting you at ...event name..., I’d love to stay in touch.” Keep it simple, but do it. That’s how networking becomes relationships.

Cold outreach

How to reach out to companies that aren't even hiring

As said before, some of the best jobs in the UAE are never posted. They go to people who were already known. Already visible. Already connected.

So what do you do when your dream company isn’t advertising a job, but you know you could add value there?

You don’t wait.
You reach out.
You do it smart.
And you don’t sound like a robot or a desperate job hunter.

STEP 1: Do your research

Start with the company's website and LinkedIn page.

What do they actually do? Who are their clients? What kind of roles do they normally hire for? Is their team growing or shrinking? Do they have recent press, funding, expansion?

Look for clues...

If you're in HR and you notice they just hired 20 people, they might need onboarding or training help.
If you're in marketing and see a new product launch, maybe they're building a team.
If you're in operations and you see job titles like "logistics coordinator" or "warehouse manager," that gives you a hint of where you might fit.
You are not messaging them blindly. You're showing that you understand their business and how you could help.

STEP 2: FIND THE RIGHT PERSON

Go to the "People" tab on their LinkedIn. Look for someone in senior leadership, HR, or head of department in your field. Remember... always connect two levels above you, not someone at your level. They can't hire you and they're not likely to refer you.

STEP 3: WRITE A MESSAGE THAT SHOWS VALUE

Here's what not to say:

"Hi, I'm looking for a job in your company. Please consider my CV." No one will answer that. It shows zero research, zero connection, and zero value.

Instead, write like this:

Hi, my name is (your name), and I'm currently exploring new opportunities in (your field). I have (number) years of experience in (industries), and I specialise in (your categories).

In my last role, I (insert one or two achievements).

I noticed your company has been growing in (area), and I'd love to stay in touch in case anything opens up where I could contribute.

That's it. Short. Honest. Focused. Human.

STEP 4: FOLLOW UP WITHOUT BEING ANNOYING

If they don't reply after a week or two, send one message:

Just checking in to see if there might be an opportunity to speak in the future. Either way, I'll keep following your company's updates and wish you continued success.

Then stop.

Never push. Never spam. But don't disappear either. Stay visible with valuable LinkedIn posts, comments, or updates so when something does open, they remember you.

Final thoughts

You made it to the end. And I'm proud of you for that.

I know job hunting in the UAE isn't easy. It can feel overwhelming, confusing, and exhausting, especially when you keep hearing nothing back.

But here's what I want you to remember.

If you follow everything in this Playbook step by step, you're not just applying. You're building a system that actually works.

From fixing your CV, to creating a LinkedIn profile that feels like you, to writing a short and clear cover letter, to finding jobs through career pages, to identifying the right companies, using recruitment agencies, networking through events, and reaching out cold, this is how real job searching is done.

And yes, it takes work. But if you want the right job, with the right salary and the right company, this is the path. Random mass applying will not get you there.

And if you ever feel tired of being rejected, or if you've gone months without a single interview, I want you to know that's not your fault. You were never taught how this market works. But now you know.

And you don't have to do it alone.

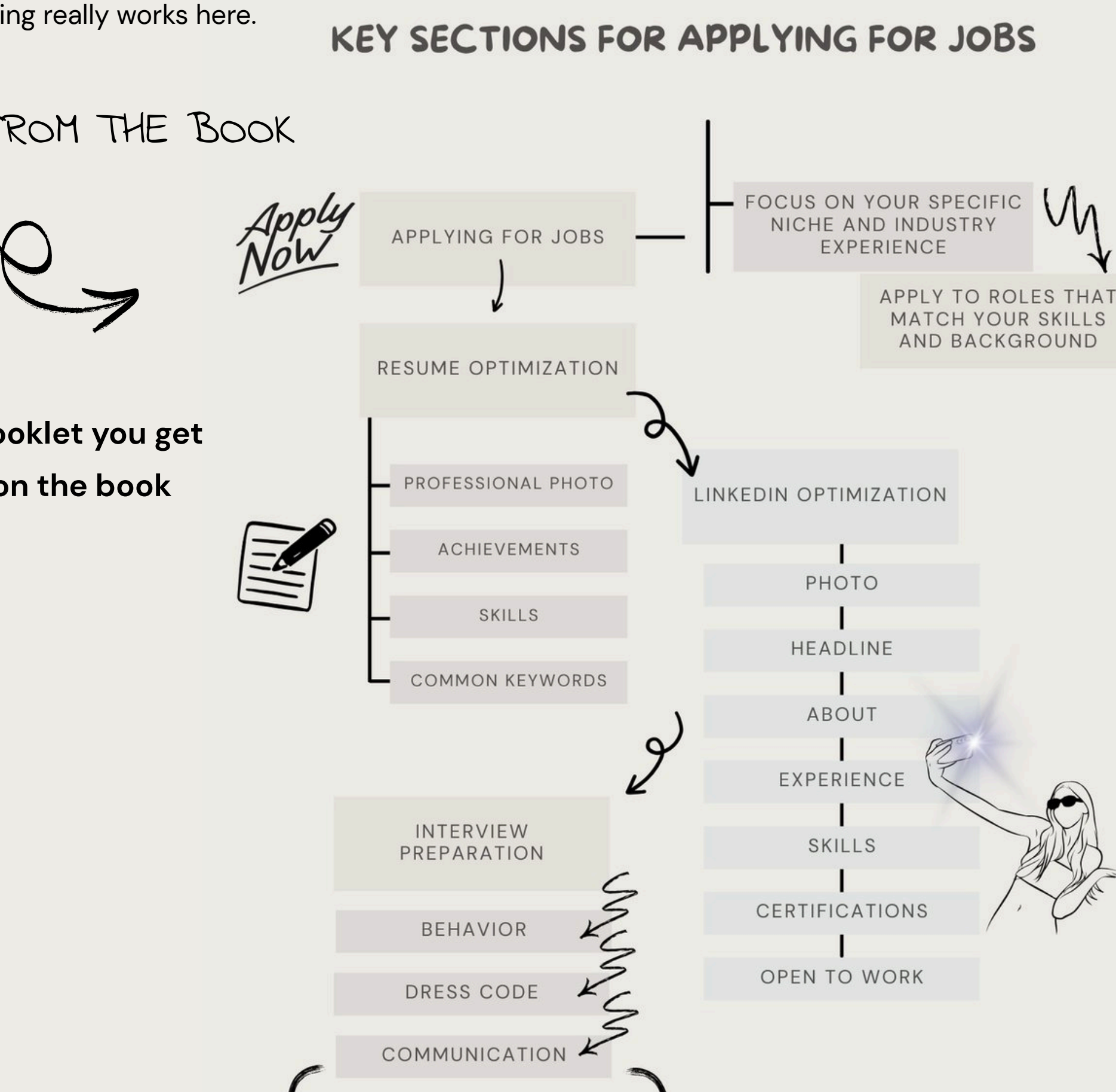
I’ve spent over 12 years in HR across Europe, the US, Latin America, and the UAE. I’ve reviewed over 10,000 CVs and hired more than 1,000 people. I also wrote a book for everyone who want to move to the UAE, **From Jobless to Empowered, the UAE edition**, because I know how different this market really is. In the book you will learn:

- How to understand the UAE job market and what’s actually going on behind the scenes when you apply
- A clear guide to rewriting your CV, not just to pass the ATS but to make recruiters want to read it
- Job interview tips that actually help, so you feel prepared and not panicked
- What to change on your LinkedIn so you start getting noticed by the right people
- How to negotiate your salary with confidence, even if you're not sure what you're worth yet
- How to tap into the hidden job market and find roles before they’re ever posted
- A list of the most in demand jobs in the UAE right now

Whether you're just starting out, changing careers, or trying again after months of rejections, this book gives you the steps you need to finally move forward, based on how hiring really works here.

With this booklet you get

40% OFF on the book



I know what recruiters want. I know how to help you pass each step. And I know how to make your profile finally get seen. If you're ready to stop guessing and start getting results, we can fix your CV, LinkedIn, and cover letter together. If you're not sure whether what you have is strong enough, just reach out. DM me on LinkedIn or email me and say:

Hi, I read your Playbook and I'd love for you to check if my CV, LinkedIn, and cover letter are ready for the UAE market.

I'll be happy to take a look.

You can also visit our website for all the services and prices we offer. There are constantly discounts on our services, if you don´t see any feel free to message me linkedin.com/in/darija-mesko.

Because I know this matters.

And I know you've got this.

Maybe you just need that one piece that opens the right door.

Whatever happens, don't give up.

You're not invisible.

You're just one strong application away from being seen.

I'm here if you need me.

Best,

Darija Mesko

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